



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)
GENERAL FOUNDATION COURSES IN ENGLISH
SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC)

Programme	BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS				
Course Code	ENG6FS113				
Course Title	ACADEMIC WRITING				
Type of Course	SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC)				
Semester	6				
Academic Level	100-199				
Course Details	Credits	Lecture	Tutorial	Practical	Total Hours
	3	3	-	-	45
Pre-requisites	Basic Knowledge of English grammar and vocabulary.				
Course Summary	The course equips students with the critical understanding of conventions and practises in academic writing, enabling them to produce factually precise, authentically presented, original arguments across various genres of scholarly communication.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category #	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	Demonstrate a critical understanding of the conventions of academic writing in Humanities.	U, Ap	F, C	Assignment/ Group Discussion/ Test/Exam
CO2	Refine critical thinking skills through observing, analysing and synthesising complex ideas, information and resources.	U, Ap, An, E	F, C	Assignment/ Presentation/Peer Review/ Test/Exam
CO3	Enhance knowledge of academic language standards on grammar, vocabulary, syntax and formatting.	R, U, Ap	F, C	Classroom Activity Handouts/Viva-Voce/ Test/Exam
CO4	Foster the ability to employ research tools and strategies, including digital resources, to develop compelling arguments supported by evidence from authentic sources.	Ap, An, E	C, P	Written Assignment/ Viva-voce/ Test/Exam
CO5	Cultivate proficiency in writing processes, including drafting, revising, editing and proofreading to produce different genres of academic writing.	Ap, An, E, C	C, P	Assignment/Presentation/Peer Review/ Test/Exam
CO6	Practise academic etiquette displaying ethics, integrity and dignity in research writing, research publication and knowledge sharing.	Ap, An, E	C	Group Discussion/Debate/Viva-Voce/ Test/Exam
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hrs	Marks
I	FOUNDATIONS OF ACADEMIC WRITING		9	10
	Skill: To enable learners to develop the ability to construct clear, coherent, and well-supported academic arguments.			
	1	Basic Theory- Characteristics of academic writing, its elements and relevance.	2	
	2	Critical thinking- Asking questions, identifying research problems and suggesting solutions.	2	
	3	Critical reading various modes and types of reading required for academic pursuits and research.	3	
	4	Identifying the audience and aligning the purpose.	2	
		Suggested Activities: 1. Provide students with samples of research articles that have long winding, parenthetical and structurally complex and cumbersome sentences. Ask them if they understood the arguments and points in the document and list the reasons for lack of clarity. 2. Students are to write down the answers to a set of questions about self, text and context after reading a research article of their choice. 3. Choose a film of contemporary relevance or recent commercial success and discuss the socio-political and cultural representations in it. 4. Supply academic essays/ articles. Give learners 5 to 10 minutes to identify keywords, read the abstract, introduction and conclusion and infer the focus of the given article. 5. Each learner is to choose a topic of interest and compose a paragraph about the readers for whom the learner might develop an essay on the chosen topic.		

II	MASTERING ACADEMIC WRITING		9	10
	Skill: To refine the learners' use of advanced vocabulary, complex sentence structures, and precise academic terminology to enhance clarity and sophistication in their writing.			
	5	Grammar- Rules and conventions of grammar particular to academic writing. Tenses-Appropriate Sentence Construction and Usages.	3	
	6	Vocabulary- Academic word list, phrases and research language.	1	
	7	Format- Formatting exercises and rules, citing sources, preparing bibliography, with reference to MLA Handbook latest edition.	2	
	8	Writing- Research/ Thesis statement, topic sentence, methodology, introduction and conclusion, editing and revising, proofreading, title of the article, responding to different types of questions.	3	
		Suggested Activities: 1) Learners are to maintain workbooks that will contain all the work done during the course, including writing samples, grammar exercises, editing practice and various types of academic writing engaged in during the semester. This should be submitted for evaluation regularly. 2) Distribute handouts with grammar exercises. 3) Supply a list with academic words and phrases that learners can refer to. 4) Divide the class into groups. Distribute the important sections of MLA's latest edition among them. Ask them to condense the given portions into easy, readable and simple notes. Compile these into a single document and share them with the class. 5) Screen the video 'Write Well. Start Writing Now'.(TedxTalk) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KUKgJsvoDUk 6) Distribute essays/ articles and ask students to prepare the research statement. 7) Ask the learners to write an abstract/ proposal/ introduction/ conclusion from home. During class, give them 10 minutes to edit and revise their work.		

II I	WRITING STRATEGIES AND RESEARCH PLANNING		9	15
	Skill: To equip the learners with techniques for effective organization, argument development, and systematic research integration in their academic writing.			
	9	Research Gaps in Literature- Classic literature gap, the Disagreement gap, the Contextual gap and the Methodological gap.	2	
	10	Techniques for Research- Familiarise activities like brainstorming, Q&A sessions, academic arguing, free writing, looping, rapid writing, framing questions, and preparing answers for possible questions.	3	
	11	Note-taking and Summarising- Concept map, note-taking practices, summarising, paraphrasing, structuring ideas	2	
	12	Technology-Aided Writing- Digital Resources and AI tools: availability and ethical use (N-list, Infilbnet, Online Libraries, e-Journals, AI tools like Grammarly, Concensus, Zotero, Scholarcy, Typeset.io etc.)	2	
		Suggested Activities: 1) Allot to each learner a famous personality belonging to fields like science, technology, medicine, space travel, literature, social activism, history etc. and initiate a group discussion to find a solution for issues of contemporary relevance. Each learner has to contribute keeping in mind the characteristics of the allotted personality. 2) Each learner can be encouraged to maintain an 'idea journal' to note down thoughts, questions and short descriptions of academic ideas. 3) Learners can be encouraged to maintain a daily diary/ journal in which they are to write down one page describing their day. However, they should write only for 10 to 15 minutes, must not stop in between, need not worry about mistakes and must not revise the entries. 4) Screen the following videos: a) The Writing Process of the University of Melbourne https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ewAkojTzutY&list=PLJSPTc0K-PlTaEBbDi5e15O6a4AMQlqwg b) The Craft of Writing Effectively of the UChicago Social Sciences https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vtIzMaLkCaM 5) Draw a concept map based on a research topic on the board. Ask each learner to add to the map. 6) Conduct hands-on workshops to familiarise learners with digital tools.		

IV	ACADEMIC WRITING ESSENTIALS		9	15
	Skill: To instil in the learners the fundamental skills of academic ethics and writing to produce well-organized and error-free academic texts.			
	13	Initial Writing- Drafting aims and goals, writing an abstract, formulating a hypothesis, literature review, paragraph writing and writing with focus.	2	
	14	Types- Different types of academic writing, their formats and contents- Letter, Proposal, Case study, Dissertation/ Project Report and Research Article.	3	
	15	Academic Ethics- Plagiarism and ethical practices.	2	
	16	Originality- Summarising, highlighting the novelty, relevance and scope of research.	2	
		Suggested Activities: 1. Distribute handouts with a template for a research plan that follows the basic format of an abstract. Each learner must fill in the template about a problem identified as a research gap. 2. Divide the class into groups. Assign a different type of academic writing sample to each group and ask them to make a presentation on the characteristics of the sample given. 3. Learners are to present a proposal before a mock panel to acquire funding for their research idea. 4. Peer review of written assignments. 5. Allot a random article downloaded from open access journals/ websites from the internet. The learner must use online plagiarism check websites to check the similarity in content.		
V		OPEN ENDED	9	

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 16 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 36 transaction hours for the fixed modules and 9 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (25 marks) are split between the open-ended module (5 marks) and the fixed modules (20 marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 16 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

1. Babin, Monique, et al. The Word on College Reading and Writing. Open Oregon Educational Resources, n.d.
2. Biggs, Michael and Henrik Karlsson, editors. Routledge Companion to Research in the Arts. Routledge, 2011.

3. Graff, Gerald and Cathy Birkenstein. They Say/ I Say: The Moves that Matter in Academic Writing. W. W. Norton and Company, 2010.
4. Kane, Thomas S. The Oxford Essential Guide to Writing. Berkley Books, 2000.
5. Kothari, C. R. Research Methodology: Methods and Techniques. New Age International Publishers, 2004.
6. Morley, John. Academic Phrasebank. The University of Manchester, 2014.
7. Peterson, Patricia Wilcox. Developing Writing: Writing Skills Practice Book for EFL. US Department of State: Office of English Language Programs, 2003.
8. Walliman, Nicholas. Research Methods: The Basics. Routledge, 2011.
9. (<https://2012books.lardbucket.org/books/writers-handbook/s05-02-posing-productive-questions.html>)

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:

	PS O1	PS O2	PS O3	PS O4	PS O5	PS O6	PO 1	PO2	PO 3	PO 4	PO 5	PO 6	PO 7
CO 1	2	1	1	3	-	-	3	-	3	1	1	1	3
CO 2	1	1	3	3	1	1	2	2	3	-	3	1	3
CO 3	3	3	1	1	-	-	2	-	3	-	-	-	1
CO 4	2	2	2	3	2	1	1	2	2	3	2	1	2
CO 5	2	3	1	3	1	-	2	-	3	2	2	1	2
CO 6	-	1	3	3	3	1	3	2	3	2	1	2	2

Correlation Levels:

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment Rubrics:

- Components: Theory - Modules I, II, III and IV (3 credits), Open Ended - Module V
- Total Marks – 75: Internal – 25 marks (20 Theory + 5 Open-ended Module) and External – 50 marks

Mapping of COs to Assessment Rubrics:

	Internal Exam	Assignment	Seminar Presentations	End Semester Examinations	Viva Voce
CO 1	✓	✓		✓	
CO 2	✓	✓	✓	✓	
CO 3	✓			✓	✓
CO 4	✓	✓		✓	
CO 5	✓	✓	✓	✓	
CO 6	✓			✓	✓